



IN410

Cryptography and Secure Communications

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Course Syllabus

- Context
- History/ Classical ciphers
- Symmetric Encryption
- Cryptographic hash functions
- Key Exchange & Public Key Cryptography
- Authentication

Credits



- The following slides are the adaptation of
 - Lecture slides of Lawrie Brown based on William Stallings book “Cryptography and Network Security: Principles and Practice”
 - Lecture Slides of Dan Boneh – Stanford University
 - Lecture slides of Pawel Wocjan – University of Central California
 - Lecture Slides of Ahmed Serhrouchni – Telecom ParisTech
 - Others (References in the note section)



X.509 CERTIFICATES



Motivations

- Asymmetric cryptography is used for:
 - Evidence-oriented services
 - Distribution of session keys
 - Longer service life
 - Need to revoke them if necessary



Motivations (cont'd)

- Problem of Asymmetric cryptography
 - The **distribution of public keys**
 - **Public Key Authentication**
 - A public key belongs to the one who claims to be the holder
 - The **use associated to the public key**
- The answer is the **certificate** and **associated infrastructure** for their **management**



Motivations

- "Certificate" = belongs to an authority or institution
- The content = “**Authentic**” Information
- Dictionary: « an official document attesting a fact » (Oxford Dict.)
- Presence of a "recognized" authority attesting to the veracity of the content.
- **Certificate = “signed” Document**



Objective & Applications

- **Main Objective:** link *identity* and *public key* through the signature of a trusted third party
- Applications
 - **Personal certificate** => to authenticate a user.
 - **Server Certificate** => to authenticate a server
 - **Developer certificate** => sign/authenticate the developed programs and macros.
 - **Certificate of Certification Authority** => sign certificates



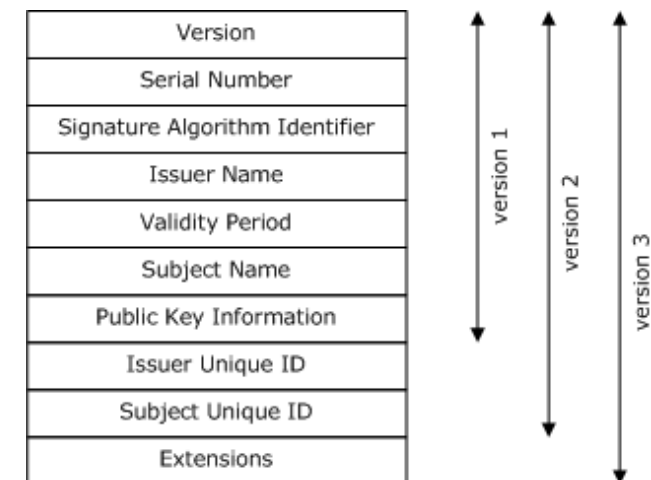
X.509 Certificate - Definition

- Data structure for linking various elements by means of a signature of a Certification Authority (CA)
 - The subject, the key, the certificate issuer, validity conditions, ...

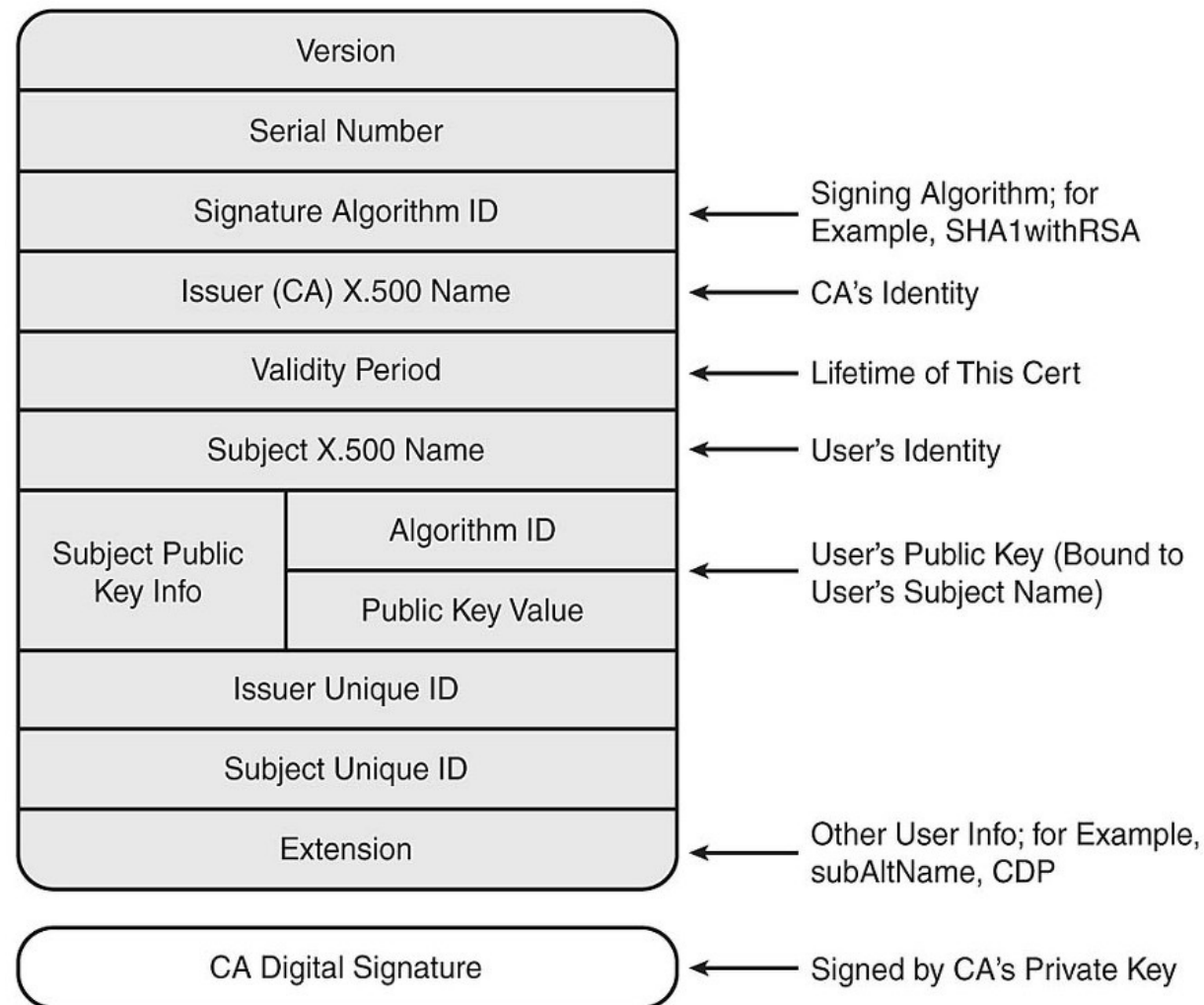


X.509 Certificates

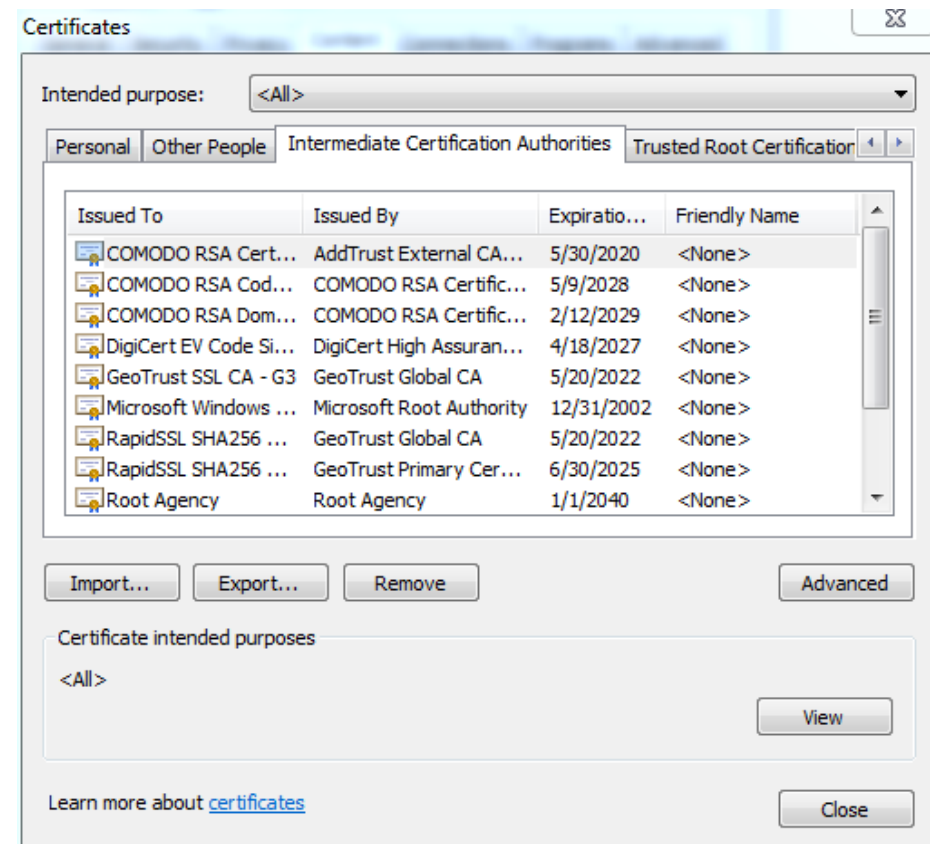
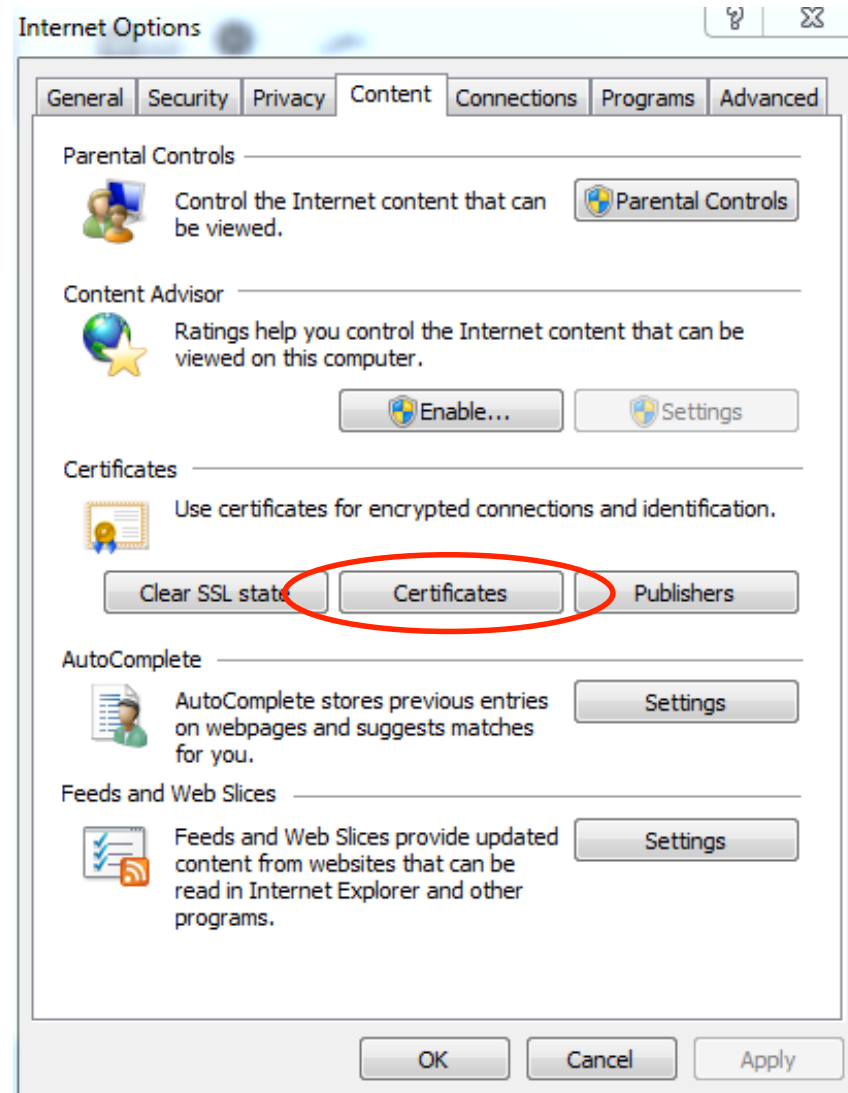
- Standard
 - ITU-T X.509(03/2000), or ISO/IEC 9594-8
 - Public Key and Attribute Certificates
 - [RFC 5280: Internet X.509 Public Key Infrastructure Certificate and Certificate Revocation List \(CRL\) Profile](#)
- Versions:
 - 1988 : v1
 - 1993 : v2 = v1 + 2 new fields
 - 1996 : v3 = v2 + extensions



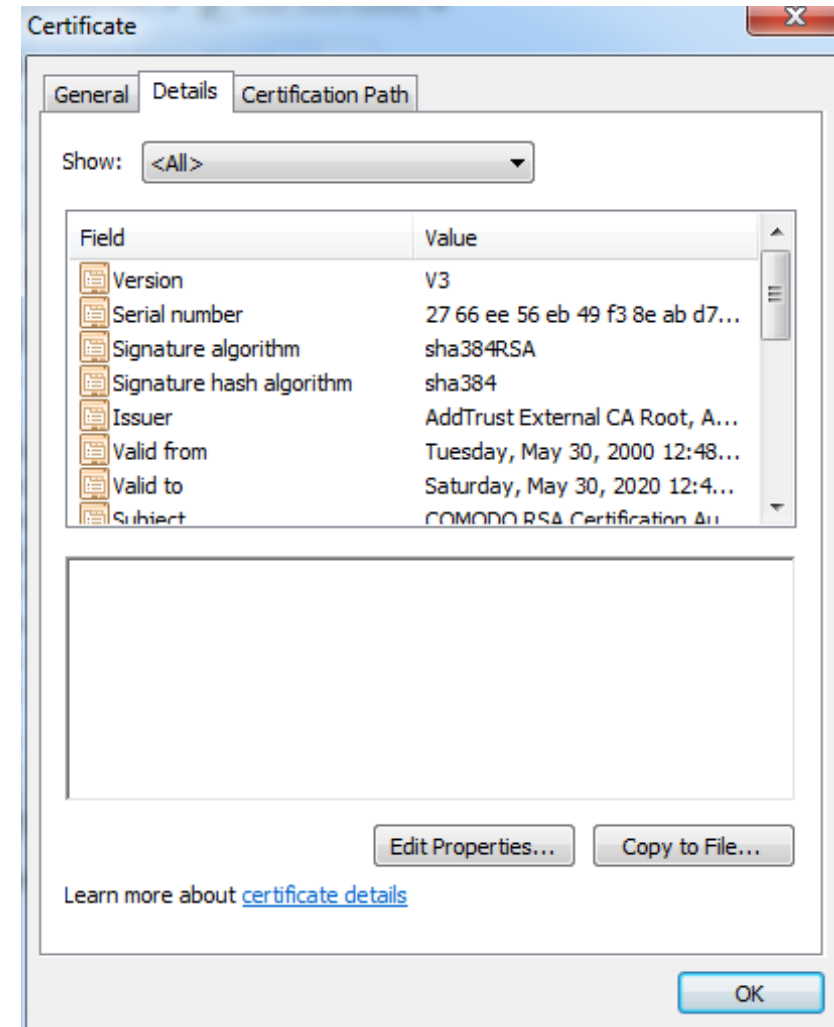
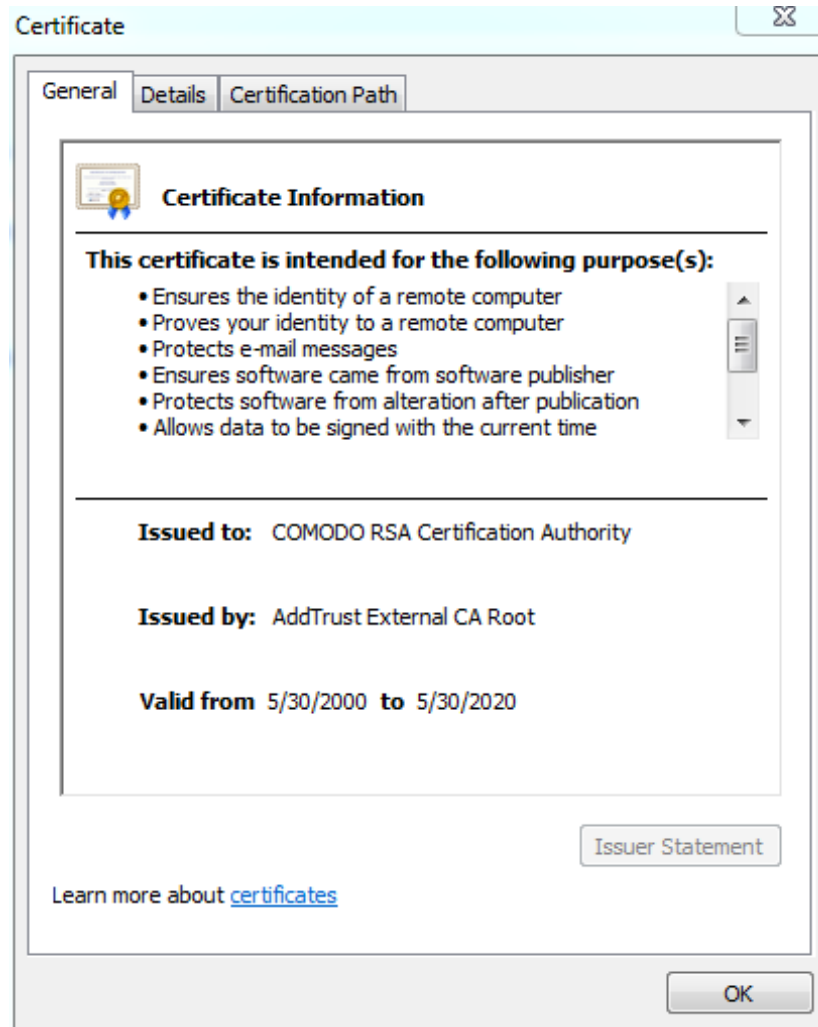
X.509 Certificates



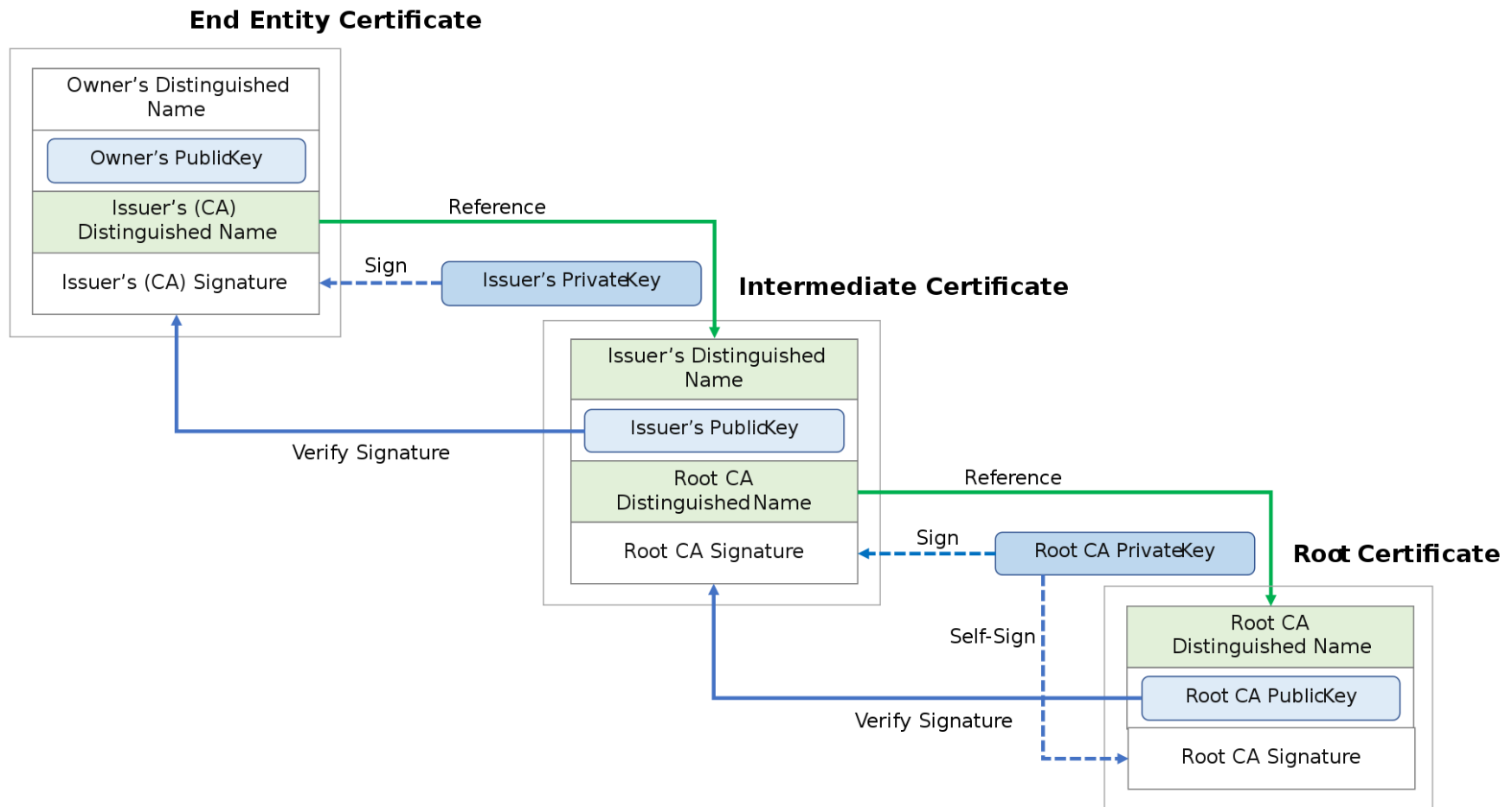
X.509 Certificate - Example



X.509 Certificate - Example



Certificate Chain of Trust





Extensions

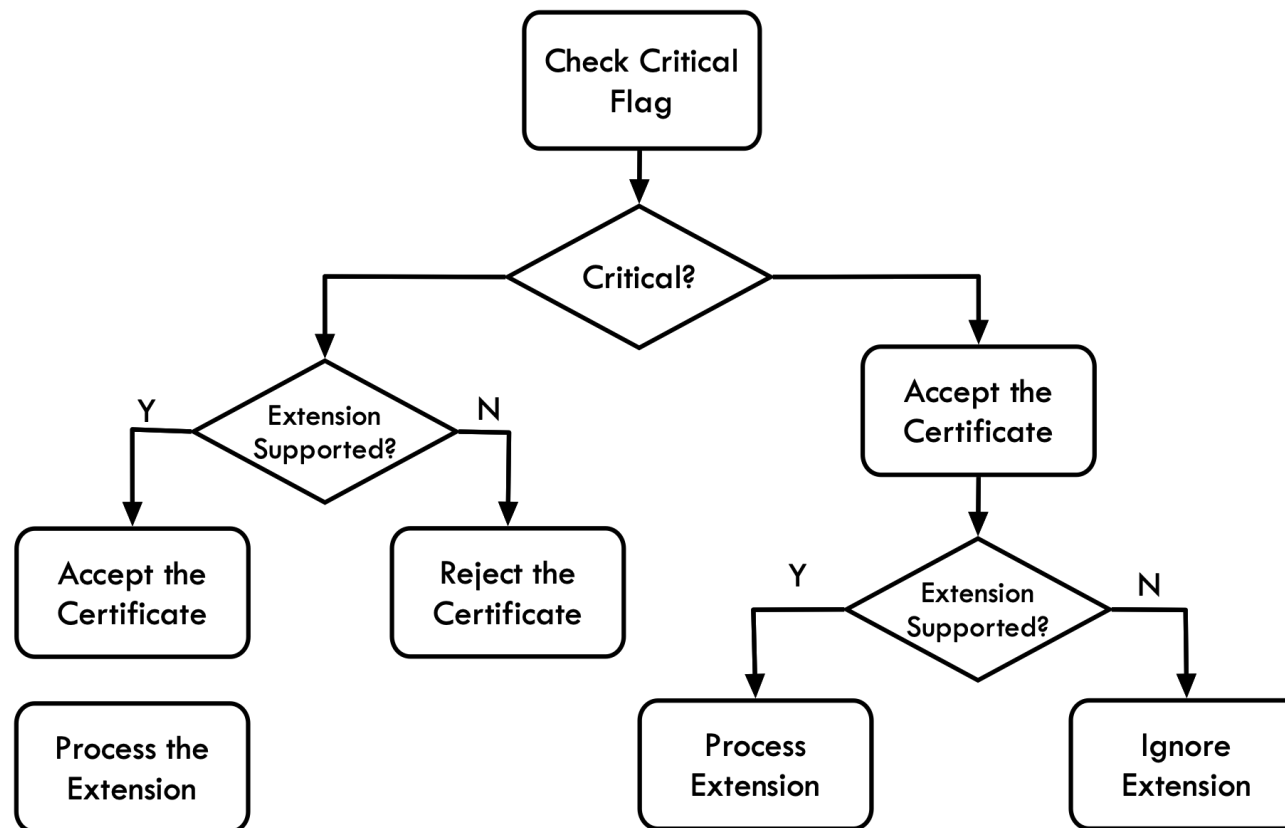
- The initial goal of certificates is to link **identity** and **public key** through the signature of a trusted third party
- **To cover wider services**
 - Need to associate additional information with the public key
- **The extension is to add new fields to certificates**
- Extensions are standardized in general
 - *Possibility to define specific extensions*
- If the application does not support a **critical** extension, it « drops » the certificate.

Extensions



- Extension structure
- **Type** is unique for each extension

Extension Type	Critical Flag (0 or 1)	Value
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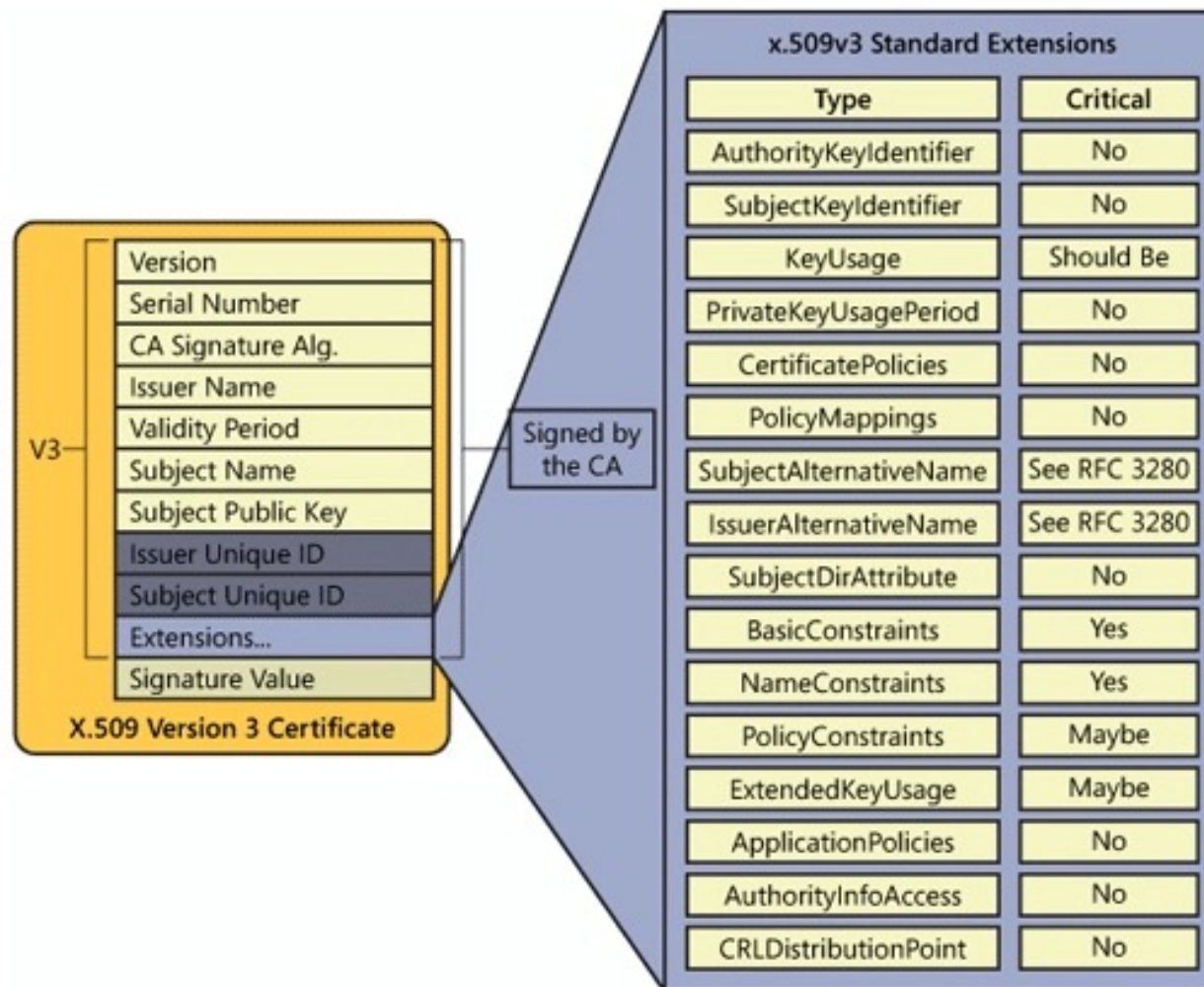




Extensions

- Extensions:
 - Naming the subject and signer (issuer)
 - Public / private keys
 - Revocation
 - Certification Policy
 - Roles
 - More ... logo, ...

Extensions





Extensions - Most Common

- **Basic Constraints**

- used to indicate whether the certificate belongs to a CA.

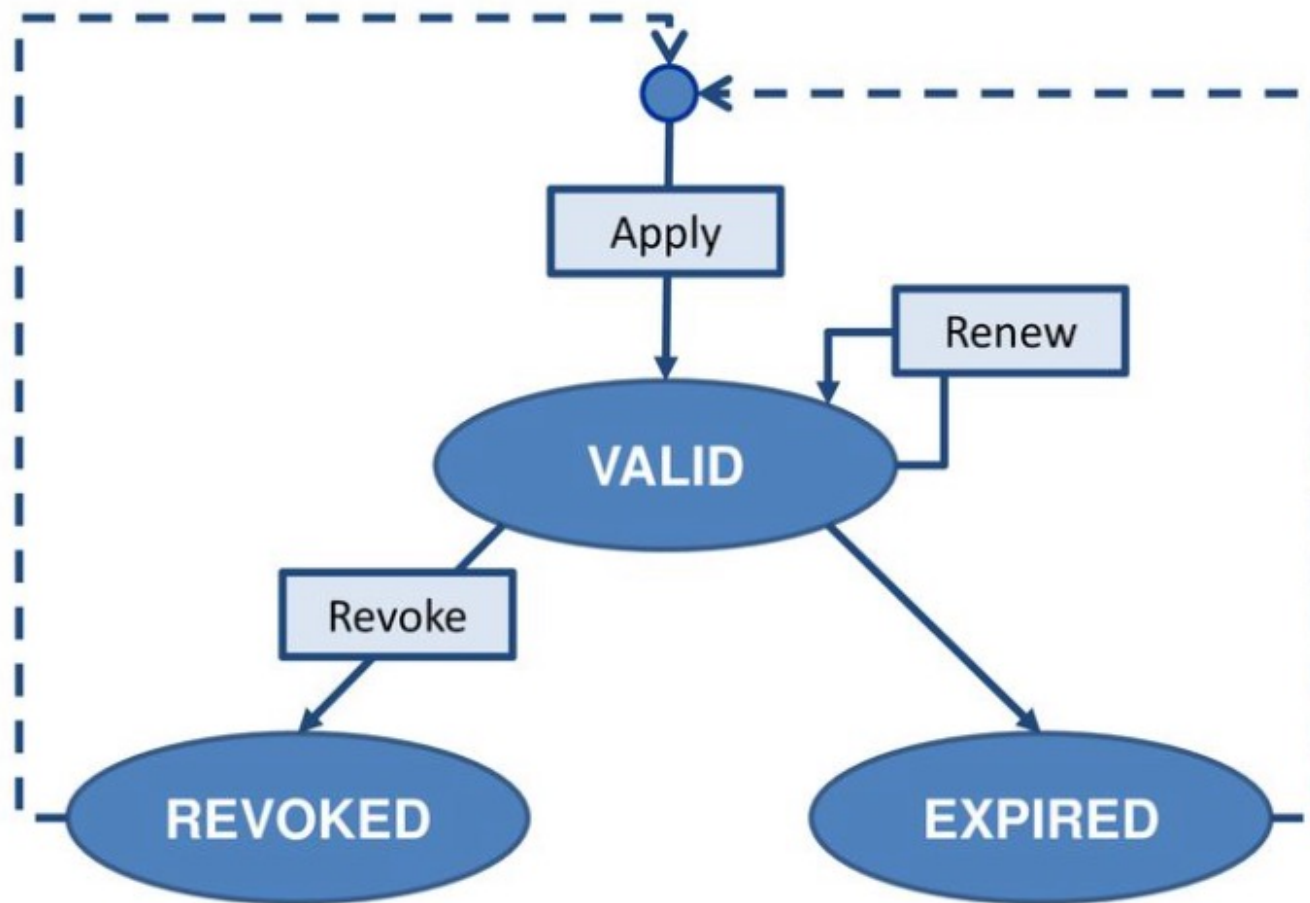
- **Key Usage**

- Specify the cryptographic operations which may be performed using the public key contained in the certificate
- Example: *Encryption only*

- **Extended Key Usage**

- Typically on a leaf certificate
- Indicate the purpose of the public key of the certificate
- Example: SSL Server, Secure email.

Certificate Lifecycle





Revocation

- A **certificate** can be **revoked** if:
 - Authority's private key is **compromised**
 - Private key associated with certificate is **compromised**
 - Change in status of the certificate holder
 - Suspension of the certificate holder
 - Certificate was obtained by fraud
 - ...
- The **authority of revocation** and the **certification authority** may be the same entity



Revocation

- Different methods of revocation:
 - CRLs (Certificate Revocation List)
 - CRL Distribution Points
 - Delta CRLs
 - OCSP (Online Certificate Status Protocol)
- A certificate includes an **extension** that indicate the supported revocation method(s)



Revocation - CRL

- Certificate Revocation List (CRL)
 - Traditional model, supported by all platforms.
 - **Blacklist** of revoked certificates.
 - Signed by the certification authority and published in a directory
- Each entry contains:
 - Certificate serial number
 - Date of revocation
 - Other information as the reason of revocation
 - ...

Revocation - CRL: Pros. & Cons.



- Advantages

- Simple
- Compatible with applications

- Disadvantages

- Revocation server must periodically publish a new CRL
 - Even if no certificate was revoked since last CRL
- Size of the CRL can significantly increase
 - Overhead in communication, processing and storage
- Expiry at the same date of the CRL

Revocation - CRL Distribution Points



- Principle: divide the CRL into smaller parts
- Each certificate contains information that allows the application to check its validity in the right place
- Advantages
 - Solves the CRL increasing size problem
- Disadvantages
 - Certification verification place is hard-coded in the certificate
 - Introduces implementation complexity



Revocation - Delta CRL

- Provides information about certificates whose **status has changed since the last CRL**.
- **Reduces the amount of data to be exchanged** with the Revocation Authority
- Delta CRL is associated with a reference CRL



Revocation - OCSP

- OCSP: Online Certificate Status Protocol
 - RFC 2560
 - Enables **real-time verification** of the validity of the certificate
 - Based on a **client-server model** (Request / Response)
 - The OCSP server can use the CRL to respond
- The application hosts a client that queries the OCSP server on the status of the certificate
 - Server sends the status of the certificate in a signed message



Revocation - OCSP (Cont'd)

- Advantages
 - Provides up-to-date information
 - Fast response time
- Limitations
 - OCSP server has to sign all the responses
 - OCSP server private key should be highly secured (additional cost)
 - Needs high availability of server and service



PUBLIC KEY INFRASTRUCTURE (PKI)



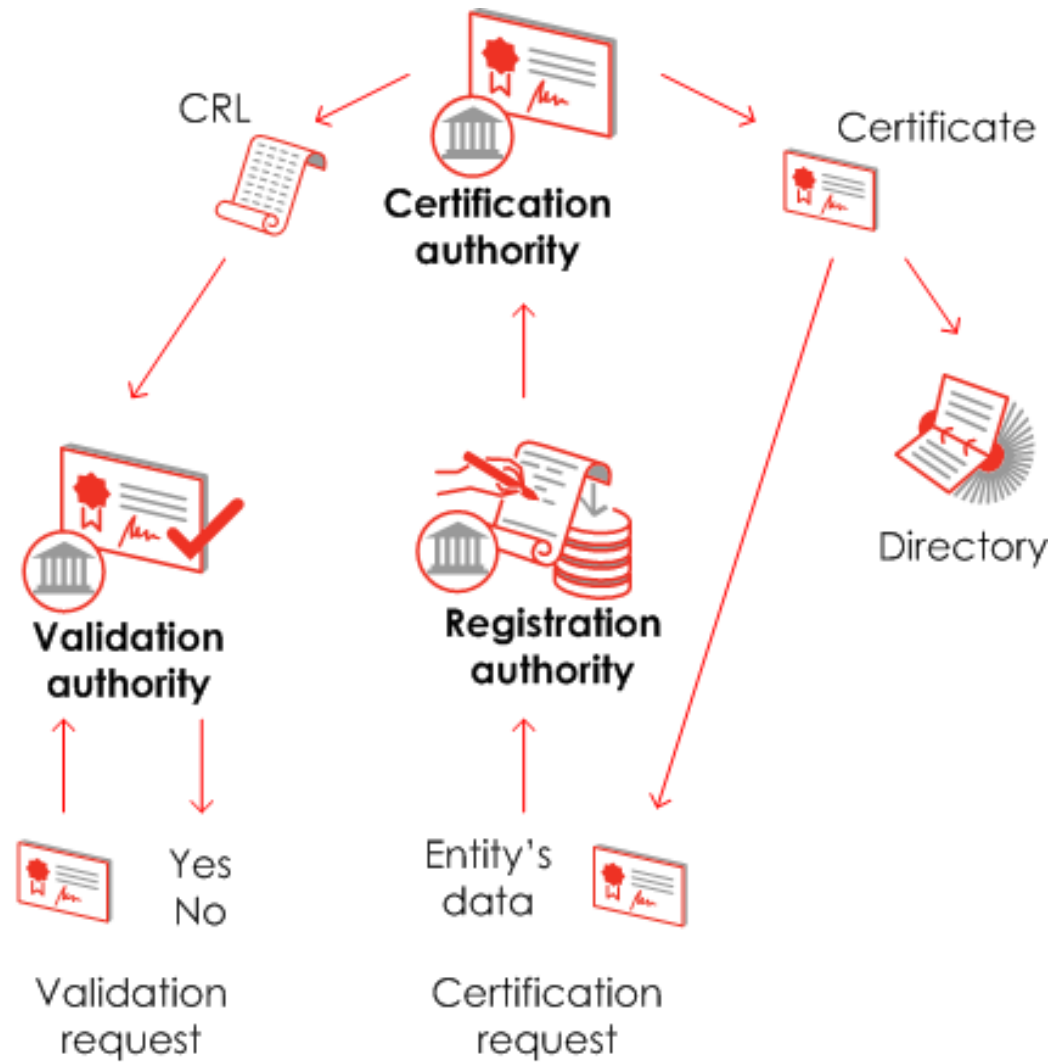
Definition

“A public-key infrastructure (PKI) is the **set of hardware, software, people, policies, and procedures** needed to create, manage, store, distribute, and revoke digital certificates based on asymmetric cryptography.

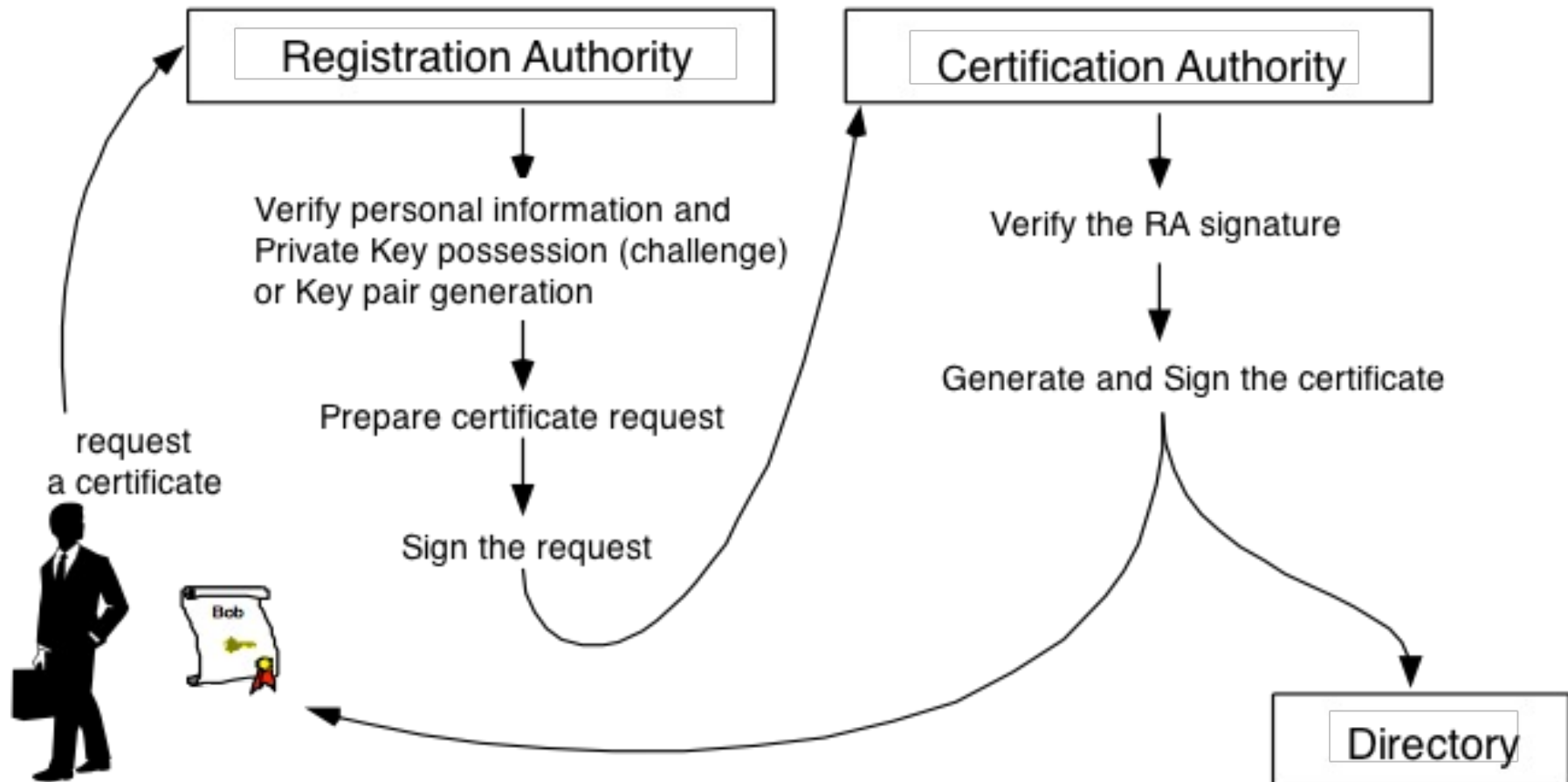
Its principal is to enable secure, convenient, and efficient acquisition of public keys”

(RFC 2822 - Internet Security Glossary)

PKI Simplified Architecture



Certificate Generation Process





Base64 Format



Base64 Encoding

- Based on an alphabet of 64 symbols
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789 + /
- A block of 24 bit divided into 6-bit block
 - A 6-bit block corresponds to a symbol of the alphabet base64
 - Padding with "=" to achieve 24-bit
 - 76 symbols per line (LF character at the end of line)

Base64 Encoding



Text content	M	a	n
ASCII	77 (0x4d)	97 (0x61)	110 (0x6e)
Bit pattern	0 1 0 0 1 1 0 1	0 1 1 0 0 0 0 1	0 1 1 0 1 1 1 0
Index	19	22	5
Base64-encoded	T	W	F

Value	Char	Value	Char	Value	Char	Value	Char
0	A	16	Q	32	g	48	w
1	B	17	R	33	h	49	x
2	C	18	S	34	i	50	y
3	D	19	T	35	j	51	z
4	E	20	U	36	k	52	0
5	F	21	V	37	l	53	1
6	G	22	W	38	m	54	2
7	H	23	X	39	n	55	3
8	I	24	Y	40	o	56	4
9	J	25	Z	41	p	57	5
10	K	26	a	42	q	58	6
11	L	27	b	43	r	59	7
12	M	28	c	44	s	60	8
13	N	29	d	45	t	61	9
14	O	30	e	46	u	62	+
15	P	31	f	47	v	63	/

Base64 Encoding



-----BEGIN RSA PRIVATE KEY-----

```
MIICXQIBAAKBgQCauoGr1KOcfwtzMy/jUeXV86WVh33NEoGro6+7+Yj36wizrP++
57QRht4q44N8lJKEsdEUZbtNKO0Gb5I9EXWNBdDsc5Kuqi aIpbszj2x6faJExZdE
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wldadxmirlls5F2llKadAkBQXCiuSqimmrXMkqM/BT5eqi xwAgNDY6UycbgyG17b
E4GSMx6X+xesblszwvUi76AH0RDQAAwweeDV/OkZlTT+
```

-----END RSA PRIVATE KEY-----